

Portfolio Analytics Venture — Updated Master Plan

July 2026 — Incorporates competitive research and positioning refinements

The Core Thesis

Build a **done-for-you fractional analytics service** targeting US RIAs managing \$50M–\$500M AUM — a segment too large to run on Excel but too small and lean to operate enterprise platforms like Orion or Tamarac. Use the service phase to fund development of a compliance-first SaaS product that eventually becomes infrastructure these firms can’t rip out.

The key insight: every competitor in this space is a software vendor. The RIA buys a license and operates it themselves. Nobody is selling the *outcome* — interpreted, compliance-grade analytics delivered by a qualified practitioner. That’s the gap.

What You’re Actually Building — The Reframe

Do not think of this as “cheaper Orion.” Think of it as three distinct layers:

Layer	What it is	Why it matters
Compliance recordkeeping	Audit trail of every suitability assessment, flag, and drift event — timestamped and exportable	This is the moat. Once an RIA has 12 months of history here, they can’t leave without losing their audit trail
Analytics engine	Performance attribution, risk metrics, allocation analysis, suitability flagging	This feeds the compliance layer — the analytical brain behind the service
Report output	Branded PDF, one-page summary, RAG dashboard	This is what the client sees. It’s the deliverable, not the product

Mental model shift: You are not selling a report generator. You are selling a compliance system that happens to produce reports.

Positioning

Not: a portfolio analytics software tool competing on price against Orion, Advyzon, or Kwanti.

Is: a **Fractional Chief Analytics Officer** — outsourced expert judgment, interpretation, and compliance-grade output, priced like fractional executive services, not like a SaaS subscription.

Why this holds up against every competitor

- vs. **Orion/Tamarac/Black Diamond** — they require dedicated ops staff, 6-12 month implementations, and five-figure contracts. A \$100M solo RIA cannot realistically operate them. You sell the *outcome* these platforms produce, operated entirely by you.
- vs. **Kwanti/Advyzon/Nitrogen** — self-serve tools. Output is only as good as the adviser's ability to interpret it. You add the human interpretation layer — a CFA-qualified practitioner flagging what matters and producing compliance-grade output.
- vs. **Investipal** — they focus on the front end of the client relationship (onboarding speed, proposal generation, winning new clients). You focus on the back end — ongoing suitability monitoring and compliance recordkeeping once the client is on board. Complementary, not competing.

The one-line positioning for sales conversations

“We give lean RIA firms the analytics infrastructure of a much larger firm, without the overhead of enterprise software or a full-time hire.”

Target Client

- **AUM range:** \$50M–\$500M, strongest fit around \$150M–\$500M
 - **Profile:** Small, lean firm — 1-3 advisers, minimal ops staff, already running some platform (Orion Foundation, Advyzon, Riskalyze) but lacking analytical depth or compliance rigour
 - **Key qualifier:** Enough revenue to absorb the retainer comfortably. A \$500M firm at ~1% fee earns ~\$5M/year — \$60-96k/year is a trivial line item for the right firm
 - **Soft ceiling:** Above ~\$500M-\$1B, firms increasingly have in-house investment/ops staff — the pitch shifts from “filling a gap” to “replacing an employee,” a harder sell
 - **Positioning note:** You sit *alongside* their existing stack, not replacing it — a much easier sell than rip-and-replace
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The Competitor Map

Direct Competitors (Analytics / Reporting Focus)

Kwanti - Closest in spirit to your V1 feature set — deep portfolio diagnostics, allocation, backtesting, stress testing - Self-serve, analytics-only, no statement scanning or compliance recordkeeping - Action: Get a direct demo in Year 1 — understand exactly where it falls short for a \$50-150M solo RIA

Investipal - AI-native, focused on onboarding speed and proposal generation - Strong on winning new clients, thin on ongoing compliance monitoring - Toronto-based startup, seemingly self-funded, thin review base — not a dominant incumbent - Key insight: They're building toward your Phase 3 vision (continuous drift monitoring) but aren't there yet — and their entry point is completely different (new client acquisition vs. ongoing stewardship)

Nitrogen (Riskalyze) - Dominates the risk-tolerance scoring layer, ~\$1,188/year - Already in most prospects' stack — position as an integration point, not a replacement target - Focused on risk-tolerance alignment and proposals, not full ongoing analytics

Adjacent Platforms (Too Heavy / Too Expensive for Your Target)

Orion - All-in-one consolidator — portfolio accounting, trading, CRM (via Redtail), risk, planning - Pricing: Foundation ~\$13k/yr, Essentials ~\$18k/yr, Advantage ~\$28k/yr - Target: \$200M–\$10B+ AUM — creeping down market but complexity still mismatched for sub-\$150M solo shops

Black Diamond (SS&C) - HNW reporting specialist, best alternative-asset support - No AI automation, steep learning curve, needs dedicated ops staff - Target: \$500M+ AUM

Tamarac (Envestnet) - Enterprise UMA/rebalancing, multi-custodial aggregation - Built for scale and complexity your target clients don't have

Addepar - Institutional analytics for UHNW/family offices handling complex alternative assets - Significant implementation lift — overkill for a \$50-500M RIA

Advyzon - Most affordable all-in-one, #1 client satisfaction 9 consecutive years (2026 T3 survey) - Broad generalist — not a specialised analytics/compliance depth play - Differentiation room: they do everything adequately, you do compliance analytics exceptionally

YCharts - Equity research and model tracking, starts ~\$2,508/year - Research tool, not a reporting or compliance platform

The Open Lane

Every player above is a software vendor. Nobody is selling **done-for-you ongoing suitability monitoring and compliance recordkeeping** specifically to lean-staffed sub-\$500M firms. That's a service positioning, not a feature gap — which is why it holds up even as AI makes the underlying analytics increasingly commoditised.

Pricing

Standard retainer: \$5,000–\$8,000/month

Benchmark this against fractional executive services — never against software subscription pricing: - Fractional COO: \$10,000–\$20,000/month - Fractional CFO: \$3,000–\$15,000/month - Outsourced CCO: well above a software subscription

If a prospect anchors on Orion/Advyzon sticker prices, the sales conversation has drifted into the wrong comparison set. Redirect immediately.

Consider a lower entry tier (~\$3,000–4,000/month) for firms at the bottom of the AUM range (~\$50-75M) to avoid losing viable prospects at the margins.

2–3 clients at standard rate = \$10,000–\$24,000/month — sufficient to fund the ~2-year post-launch build phase while living with family.

The 3-Year UK Build Plan

Year 1 — Learn and Lay Foundations

- Go deep at HSBC — observe every pain point, workflow gap, compliance friction (this is embedded market research)

- Register a UK Ltd company (£50, starts business history clock)
- Begin LinkedIn content — one post/week, portfolio analytics/wealthtech/quant themes
- Get a demo of Kwanti and Investipal — understand exactly where they fall short
- Start building analytics engine using synthetic data
- **Goal:** Know exactly what you're building and who you're selling it to

Year 2 — Build the Core Product

- **Analytics engine** — performance attribution, risk metrics, allocation analysis, suitability flagging (the V1 feature list below)
- **Compliance recordkeeping layer** — the moat. Log every suitability assessment, flag, and drift event with timestamps. Exportable audit trail.
- Get product to demo-ready state
- Begin warm outreach to US RIA owners — LinkedIn, NAPFA/XYPN communities
- Securities attorney review of service boundary (analytics/flags vs. tailored recommendations) — do this before any paid engagement
- **Goal:** Working product with compliance layer, first US relationships forming

Year 3 — Position for the Move

- Wrap a basic UI around the compliance dashboard — doesn't need to be polished, needs to be real
- Get it in front of 2-3 US RIAs informally — feedback, not revenue
- Attend a US wealthtech conference (T3, Future Proof, XYPN Annual)
- Line up 2-3 near-ready clients before landing
- Wind down or restructure any UK activity as remote-friendly
- **Goal:** Step off the plane with a real product, warm pipeline, and relationships ready to convert

US Launch Plan

Financial Reality

- Living with parents — eliminates rent burden
- Wife available for part-time work if needed
- Max runway: ~2 years before reassessing
- **Critical:** clients must be lined up before landing, not found after arrival

Post-Launch Timeline

Period	Focus
Months 1–6	Convert warm relationships to paying contracts
Months 6–18	Deliver service, build product in parallel — consulting funds development
Months 18–24	Clear signal needed — product traction and client growth, or reassess

The Scaling Path

Phase	Model	Timeline
Done-for-you service	You run everything, 2-3 clients, \$5-8k/month each	Years 1-2 post-launch
Gradual self-serve	Established clients get portal access, you focus on new client delivery	Years 2-4
Primarily SaaS	Platform is the product, optional managed service tier for clients who want it	Years 4+

The moat is not the software. It's that you'll have been embedded in these firms' compliance workflows long enough that switching becomes genuinely painful.

V1 Python Build — Feature List

Must Build First (Core Analytics Engine)

- 1. Performance Attribution** - Time-weighted return (TWR) vs benchmark (S&P 500, 60/40, custom) - Attribution by asset class, sector, individual holding - Period comparisons: MTD, QTD, YTD, 1Y, 3Y
- 2. Risk Metrics** - Annualised volatility - Sharpe and Sortino ratios - Maximum drawdown and recovery period - Beta vs benchmark - Value at Risk (VaR) — historical and parametric
- 3. Allocation Analysis** - Current vs target allocation - Drift from target — rebalancing trigger flags - Concentration risk — single stock, sector, geography - Correlation matrix across holdings
- 4. Suitability Flagging** - Portfolio risk metrics vs client stated risk profile - Mismatch detection with RAG status - Compliance paper trail output

Build Second (The Moat)

- 5. Compliance Recordkeeping Layer** - Timestamped log of every suitability assessment run - Record of every flag raised and its resolution - Drift history — when portfolios moved outside tolerance and what happened - Exportable audit trail formatted for SEC examination - This is what makes clients unable to leave

V2 Differentiators (Once V1 Is Proven)

- 6. Factor Exposure Analysis** — Fama-French factor loadings (market, size, value, momentum, quality)
- 7. Monte Carlo Simulation** — probability distribution of outcomes over 10/20/30 year horizons
- 8. Stress Testing** — 2008 GFC, 2020 COVID crash, 2022 rate spike scenario overlays
- 9. Fee Drag Analysis** — total expense ratio across holdings, long-term impact on outcomes

Output Formats

Format	Purpose
PDF Report (4–6 pages)	White-labelled with RIA branding, client-ready
One-page summary	For use in client meetings
Excel export	RIA internal use and further analysis
RAG dashboard	Red/amber/green flags for at-a-glance portfolio health
Audit trail export	Compliance recordkeeping — SEC examination ready

Compliance Foundations (Before Any Client Data)

- ☐ Cyber liability insurance — \$1,500–3,000/year, \$1M minimum (Coalition, At-Bay, Chubb)
- ☐ Data Processing Agreement (DPA) — lawyer reviewed, ~\$500–1,000
- ☐ Written Information Security Policy
- ☐ Breach notification procedure
- ☐ MFA on every account
- ☐ Securities attorney review of service boundary — analytics/flags only, no tailored recommendations

Data transfer: SFTP (day one) → AWS S3 with IAM controls (quickly). No Google Drive, no Dropbox, no email attachments.

Key regulations: Regulation S-P, GLBA, state privacy laws (CCPA most stringent).

Suggested Python Stack

Component	Library
Data manipulation	<code>pandas</code> , <code>numpy</code>
Financial calculations	<code>scipy</code> , <code>statsmodels</code>
Factor models	<code>pandas-datareader</code> , <code>empyrical</code>
Monte Carlo	<code>numpy</code> (custom)
Visualisations	<code>matplotlib</code> , <code>plotly</code>
PDF generation	<code>reportlab</code> or <code>weasyprint</code>
Excel export	<code>openpyxl</code> or <code>xlsxwriter</code>
Data ingestion	<code>pandas</code> CSV/Excel parsers

Key Risks

1. **Sales cycles** — 3–6 months to close even warm leads; pipeline must exist before landing in the US
2. **Consulting purgatory** — busy enough that you can't build, but not charging enough to justify the distraction. Guard against this hard.
3. **Employment contract** — verify IP ownership and outside business interest clauses at HSBC before building anything

4. **Custodian data complexity** — standardise on export formats initially; live data feed integration comes later
5. **Scaling the service** — done-for-you doesn't scale past ~10-15 clients without hiring or productising faster. Have a clear trigger point for when to accelerate the SaaS transition.

Updated July 2026. Read alongside the Python build reference when ready to begin development.